



RENJ starcross



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RENJ **starcross**



*** foreword

welcome to "starcross," a collection of 13 poems that weave together the threads of connection across star-crossed boundaries. within these lines, you'll find the echoes of longing, the whispers of desire, and the bittersweet ache of unattainable love. it's a journey of grappling with the push and pull of emotions, of navigating the delicate balance between yearning and acceptance. of all my collections, "starcross" feels like a letter addressed to "you," a testament to the power of poetry to bridge the divide between hearts.

in "starcross," i find myself navigating the delicate balance between desire and reality, between yearning and acceptance. it serves as the sister collection to my latest release, "starrise," marking a progression in my exploration of emotions. while "starrise" delved into the depths of what i truly feel, "starcross" serves as the mirror reflecting the implications and consequences of those feelings, guiding me to understand where they may lead.

yours,
RENJ

WE WERE NOTHING BUT RUNNING WATERS
HELD BY THE HANDS OF THOSE FAILED KNOTTERS



Take deep breaths, it'll be alright
It could be beautiful as this night
Maybe this one is right
Maybe this one is worth the fight

Yesterdays of tales ending wistfully
Tomorrows never forming fully
Still hoping this ends rightfully
Even once, even just this, hopefully

This could break myself in pieces
Or mend my dying heartcruises
Maybe this touch is one for the stories
In your cathartic grasp, maybe its not bruises

I'm slowly getting used with myself
Cooking with me as my own chef
Calculatedly picking books from my shelf
Accustomed to refusing any help

Now, I'm trying hard to hide that I'm trying
I'm trying hard to not show that I'm wanting
'Cause I long said to everybody I'm not crying
Yet your touch is defying

Time flows, I could only see how it ends
Is it something that kills or something that mends?
Maybe this one will end up right and blends
Well with your cathartic grasp that transcends

I'm laying here thinking is it already time
Maybe it's time to break the paradigm
Maybe calling you mine will not be a crime
These thoughts beating my dreading prime

11:37 pm, feeling your fever
Maybe this time, it'll finally fit together
Maybe this time, I'll pull the right lever
Maybe your cathartic grasp is mine forever

cathartic grasp

RENJ

i.



Cold February, wrapping my nights
Flowing patterns, keeping down my fights
I try to see my flickering lights
To see where I destroyed my sights

Camera of fate watching my every move
Replaying the record to see how I killed the groove
And find flecks I disapprove
Keep myself down with the demons I disapprove

Each day, I chase my breath
But not too much that I fall into death
And in painful doubt of depth
A peculiar shard strikes my dead strength

Cold February, I'm feeling unbound
Slowly by the even just the thoughts of your sound
Mirror of my thoughts losing its ground
Seeing the player to guess what I found

I try to not think about it but all it does is show
The face that made my demons blow
I try to hide it but all it does is grow
Into feelings I cannot sow

This day, I don't feel like chasing my breath
This day, somehow I'm out of death
I chambered out doubt of depth
A peculiar shard strikes, this pain isn't forever-length

And all my shipwrecks bow down the coast
And everything comes worth the cost
And I feel something that's not to be tossed
I wish, in the end of the day, I don't get double-crossed

Someday, I'd be alive without breath
Someday, I'd have my own depth
I am never going to put this feelings into depth
A peculiar shard strikes, this pain isn't all my wealth

peculiar shard

RENJ

ii.



If I could, I would buy a cheap camera
And we will escape the urban umbra
I'll take photos as we walk on summer trails
As we voyage over the rails

I would record every plunge into the blue
Every ray that comes from you
I would paint your portrait on solid rock
Or we could be alone together at a dock

Forests of crystal clear trees
With light seeping from the freeze
Golden swashes to the frozen blankets
I'll keep every trip to all the world's markets

Draped in the gown of orange sunsets
We forget that we are time's subjects
These lens will see it through
Even more than these loud people could do

Somewhere in this world
We'll find a place we could share or word
Without worry of their listening eyes
Where watching birds fly don't come with a price

We'll find that cold spring somewhere
We'll find that starcrossed center put there
Where whispers could be loud as a siren
Yet the sensitives will sleep as if they've never been

These lens are the ones to see us climb
To see the ocean on the summit, escaping time
Away from the barks of these loud papers
Nearer to the home of these cute leapers

It doesn't matter if it's somewhere north
Or south, west, east, or at an old fort
As long as it is not somewhere we fake a gloss
But a sky that would hold our hearts cross



RENJ

iv.

I pick up pieces down the drive
As I try to seek memory's hive
White ceilings beneath my chest
Hiding one of my best

Motion blurs pulling our skins
We share each other's pins
Staring at the eyes of lost
Laughing about how life has tossed

White strands of my hair
Shines beyond your black bear
Gray cover on my barking mouth
Pink tapestry on your facial south

We both talk on the sizes of our ego
Losing track of the stars as we go
Though different, our hairs are the same
Just that they get different fame

Eyes both deep brown, pseudo-deep thoughts
Pretending to know what are 'to be' and 'what nots'
Pretending how valleys are carved and mold
In the same process, we give each other cold

You style my strands into a nice line
Telling that my wet streets are fine
The ships that sail the mountains of my expectation
Docked on you being my holy imposition

You envy the run of light on my face
I envy your top place on the race
You win every battle my mind does to forget you
I see my paper planes point onto you

You hold the golden foil that wraps my head
You become the thoughts as I lay in bed
I see you as I start to close my eyes
Now, it's up for fate to roll the dice

Master in the barony of worry
Marked by rivers of dead anonymity
Made from shards of torn tapestry
My altitude kills my territory

Meandering labyrinths inside me
Moments of chagrin wanting to be free
Menacled by the hands of nervosity
Missing the streaks of what-to-be

Mesmerized by your voice
My soul picked you, it's not a choice
Meadows of wonder you poise
Meadows of rage my soul coys

Managing my kingdom, I fail
Menacing thoughts of my mind, flail
My world put away from what I fail
Master of avoidance from the grail

My lady, I fall in love, I fall too much
Majestic wonders like you shouldn't catch
Mannequin I become with beauty as such
My existence compared to you, is a botch

Martingales can't stop my demons
Marl cannot grow my lemons
Melancholy hides on my sermons
Months long, even through seasons

Morning shines, should I be in love?
My monsoon comes and I sob
Mouthing myself of what I don't have
Mute anxiety of feeling this I try to stab

Mutilated by years in the abyss
Music runs away from my kiss
Monsters are my synthesis
Must you fall into me, will you want this?

these salient stars

RENJ

vi.

Don't you ever become a stranger
As I continue to remember
I cannot be the one to tender
But hope you continue to utter

Your name spelled out by these salient stars
Our time has now gone past beyond Mars
We ran, to name it, I'd call us Lars
Crown king and queen the world couldn't parse

Blue car, to a hospital, to you
Something whispers this is not yet through
Tranced in a dream until morning dew
Something I would go back to look to

We were nothing but running waters
Held by the hands of those failed knotters
Unable to blend with the others
Time running out like tidewaters

I remember all those you asked me
"After Laughter," I said, you agree
Driving out into the Sun for free
Night has to end, and we have to flee

We connected all those the floating dots
Knowing they're not meant to be in knots
Holding on to nothing but touch-me-nots
Sinking with all out troublesome yachts

But I do hope you remember me
No matter how the world comes to be
'Til gone, I wish you would guarantee
To think even at lowest degree

Until the universe falls apart
It's never over, not to depart
The gold we wished for is in our hearts
We're to endure like those antique art



Before I leave this trance
Let me see you dance
Can you give me some time?
To watch you waltz with random rhyme

Can I see your smile?
A laugh I could hear from a mile
Just a little more while
Just let me draw your style

No rush, no force, no hurry
I could wait to clear this slurry
My mind flies at the thought of you
And you pierce my heart through

I thought at first, observation is eternal
To keep my urge in the internal
But every time to breathe
The caged feeling could only seethe

Through nights, when stars crossed our way
A sweet starcross swooped our sway
Now I find myself seeing you in mirrors
As I comb through my night errors

No rush, no force, no hurry
This heavy starcross is anything but blurry
Planets well overwatch our odyssey
Even is it rhymes with heresy

The galaxies will pull strings
But I it wouldn't be enough to make rings
I find my coat drenched with your stain
Permanent, unremovable even in rain

No rush, no force, no hurry
This starcross would not be in your worry
Tell me how to move to your land
I could live just seeing you stand



the happiest blue

RENJ

viii.

Life was when we go in corners
To talk about what lights us up
That sunder us from the mourners
The anthems that make our world stop

Ecstasy is where chaos is
There was fun in having the run
The tides of our heart like the seas
Days when it's high, or low, full, none

Music is wherever you are
The whole cosmos is inside you
Whenever you sing like a star
I become the happiest blue

Wonder is through your starry eyes
Stars kissed and made a galaxy
Same galaxy in front my eyes
Eclipsing life's brutality

Love was when you told me stories
In front of those dimming spotlights
"Unforeseen," you say, in promise
Not worth to lie about the sights

Heaven was when we discovered
That we can make it bow to us
Pistols, in lavender, covered
Shot in the dark, shot through the fuss

Heartbreak was when voids became large
Light cannot escape any void
Especially when two voids merge
It's hard to even have centroid

Loss was when the stars came to rest
Unsalvaged by four-leaf clovers
Stars spin to a point of arrest
I guess we were never over



What you see, isn't all there is
Life is nothing but a huge quiz
But with me, we'll finish the bizz
I will stick to you like a swish

I think I like you too much
Is it healthy to want you such?
Oh, I always look for your touch
Electric, putting war to sush

Oh, I can't seem to forget you
You haunt, even my dreams of new
Oh my God, look where the wind blew
Now, I'm here, all into you

Say my name, and I'll keep your sound
Oh, I miss you here on the ground
You make my head go spin around
Your eyes, your gaze to which I'm bound

You actually say funny jokes
You laugh at tiny little strokes
Your laugh, the feeling it invokes
Into wanting you, it provokes

Oh, your eyes, far from being kind
Piercing my soul, for you, I grind
And with your name my brain is signed
You're now someone I like to find

It hurts to know that I'm not yours
But the wholeness of your voice lures
My mind, hearing you, take detours
I promise, these feeling endures

How is it, living in my mind>
I can't seem to put you behind
In my eyes, the stars have aligned
Oh get me, get me to your bind



Memories run past my head at night
Just to give my brain a tumultuous fight
Murking boundary of wrong and right
And your face becomes scene of sight

It's enough to be crazy of your touch
It's enough to be wanting you this much
It's enough to wish you'd fall to my patch
It's enough to pray even if stays as such

I get ready, I get water run my head
Just to see you shine against my dread
You kiss my book like how they are read
Clear skies kissing tint of red

Memories jump from my head to yours
We imagine a creature on fours
We share the weird plot of our lores
And we ended up ending keeping scores

It's enough to be crazy of your gaze
It's enough to be wanting your face
It's enough to be touching your grace
It's enough to be brushing your trace

I get ready, and I go to school
In front of you, I look like a fool
You're so blue I want to jump in a pool
It's alright to remain on this rule

It's enough just to make me go crazy
And everything just becomes to hazy
It's enough to wait for statures to go lazy
With you, I want to become busy

I get ready, I get all beaten up
By the fate the world would never stop
Away from the glory of your holy drop
Someday, to be young and in love will be enough

it's enough

RENJ

x.



Replicas of my past come together
To haunt my existence forever
Zephyr blows to trigger my anger
Of the world that fails to tie itself together

Toppled over and over by the same reasons
Where I fail to become one the seasons
If I ever touch your torch with life lesions
Would I finally get ahold of the lessons

Grumbles you'll hear from my mind
I want you, but I'm not one of your kind
Would you even want me knowing I'm blind
Because I always look on what's behind

Firmanent filled with fiery foolishness
Rare is the occurrence of true happiness
But with you I find holiness
Forces of you pulling me back into oneness

Pavilions filled with my past
Are now covered in your cast
Even the small photos of you are made to last
And people like should put to blast

Everyone has seen right through me
But there's always more to see
Even my own thoughts are in disagree
On what color my memory should be

Now, I'm lost in our starcross
If we'd be together, would you care of my loss?
Or would you see me as your cross
And decide that I am for the toss

Because I'm scared through my bones
I'm scared of how you'll find my tones
I'm scared of how you'll see my clowns
I'm scared, maybe you'll find me overgrown



I sit with myself in slience
In a room of dark remembrance
Lying with my back against the world
Seconds to minutes I become curled

Wrapped by the warmth of my own embrace
I can't help but long for your grace
Eyes that bring shiver down my spine
A voice that makes me go off the line

Cards with your face stack on me
Your scent gets stuck on me
I see you in the shadows in the dark
And in every leaf at the park

My wish isn't my command
And destiny makes it into reprimand
I am a pebble struck in your quicksand
Buried beneath your majestic land

I wonder of the wonder in you
Especially in those eyes of distinctive hue
Sweat, peaceful, yet rough like the see
Hiding everything, I hope it includes me

Central motion steer my way
To crash and make me wish on your stay
Lucky catastrophe against the wind
That does anything but bend

But no rock stays solid in magma
All sounds must stop on a period or comma
Roads get bumpy ahead
And I can't get you out of my head

But it's my command to let you stay
At least in my mind, I could only pray
Let the crown reflect of my desire divine
For time to close its eyes as I sip a glass of wine



We were just kids yesterday
And we still are even now
It's a wrap for this day
It's time give the night a bow

It transpired like running water
I try to grasp your ghost
I wish you'd be able to remember
This loud person tied to a hose

But it's the sunset already
And I have to leave this den
I have to get going steady
I'd be right on time then

Counterfeit papers we pass
Tre gossip falling from our lips
Whispers from the higher class
I take with you the steps

Time clocks where it should not
I kill boredom with your thought
You eclipse everything I got
And in your eyes, I get caught

But sky is turning scarlet
I have to break this infatuated crime
"Goodbye," I shout with my full breath
Someday, we'd be right on time time

I'm a fish out the sea here
Care to share with your glass
You make me ride along your steer
As we run over an underpass

Sky is shimmering with stars
I am on my highest prime
We catch what are ours
Now, we are right on time

right on time

RENJ

xiii.

MAYBE

IT'S TIME

TO BREAK

THE PARADIGM



cathartic grasp
peculiar shard
an old fort
every battle my mind does
my soul picked you
these salient stars
starcross

the happiest blue
piercing my soul
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zephyr blows
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